A Level 1 Adventure

Fifth Edition Fantasy® #27

The Sacrificial Pyre of Thracia

by Scott Moore

The Caverns of Thracia

Goodman Games

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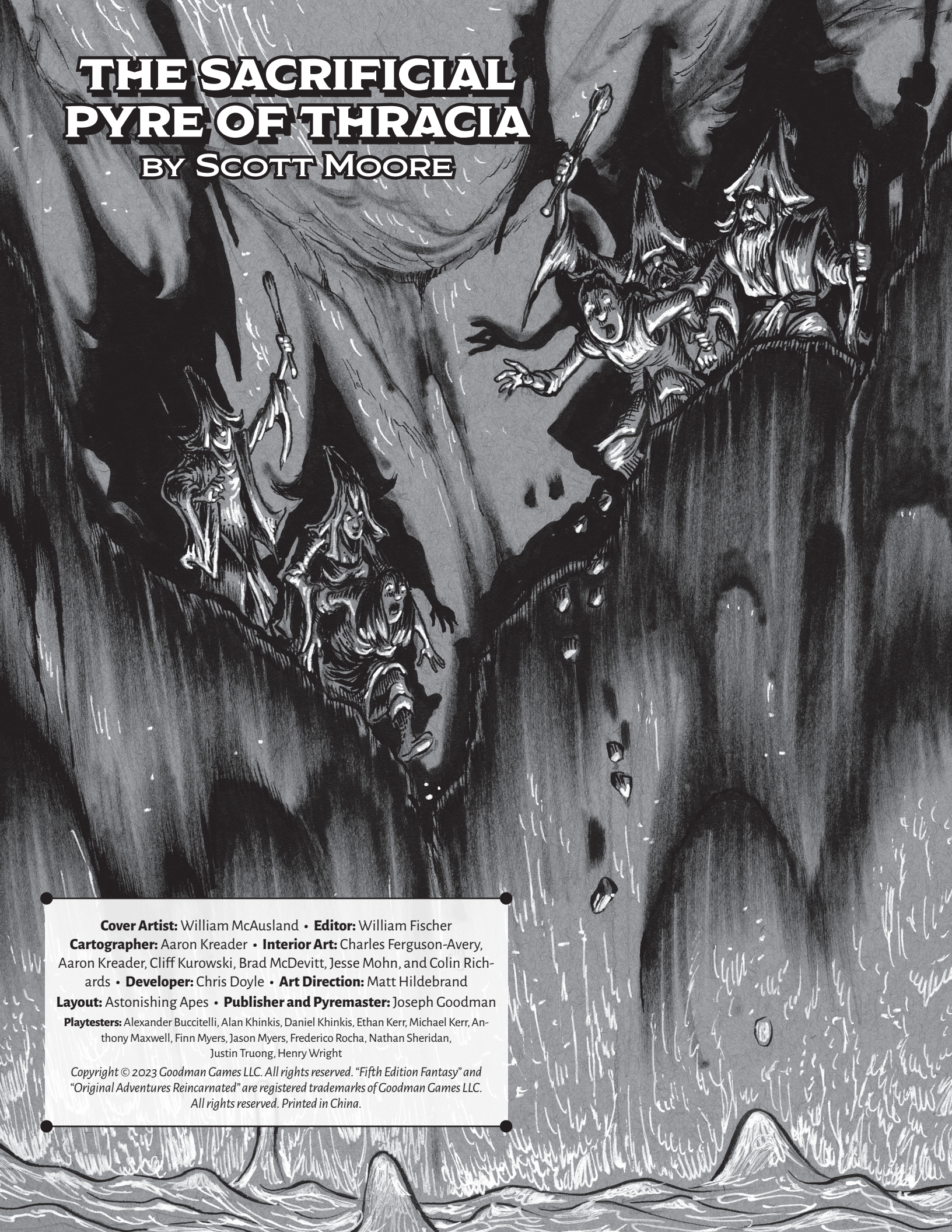

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BY SCOTT MOORE

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THE SACRIFICIAL PYRE OF THRACIA

By Scott Moore

The Sacrificial Pyre of Thracia is an adventure designed for use with the 5th edition of the first fantasy roleplaying game. It is intended for four to six 1st-level characters and can be completed in a few sessions. A variety of character classes is suggested to tackle the challenges of combat, exploration, and social interaction presented herein. Characters with outdoors skills will be beneficial for overland travel along the way, while a mix of skills and classes are recommended for dungeon exploration. The adventure is set in a region of rainforest and mountains, just north of a river near the Caverns of Thracia, and would make an excellent prequel to *OAR #9 The Caverns of Thracia*. However, it works just as well in any setting where similar geography can be found.

BACKGROUND

The cult of The Dark One is an offshoot of worshippers of Thanatos who practice torture and murder as a way of offering tribute to their deity. The cult has two major strongholds nearby: one located within an extinct volcano and a second located in the caverns beneath the ruins of the city of Thracia. Generations ago, many citizens of Thracia abandoned their home due to the presence of the cult. Their descendants now live in a small community further to the west. The cult, however, continues to grow, preying on people in the region to provide sacrifices to their dark god.

ADVENTURE HOOKS

This adventure begins with the characters heading southeast along a trail towards the settlement of Hamlet. It's up to the GM to decide why the characters are exploring the area. Several suggestions to involve the characters are presented below.

- The characters become lost while exploring or traveling back from a previous adventure. They stumble upon the trail and assume it must lead somewhere.
- The characters are searching for the fabled lost city of Thracia, without much success. They hope to replenish their supplies and gather more rumors in the next settlement they come across.
- The characters search for a settlement inhabited by descendants of refugees from fabled city of Thracia, in hopes that the people there can direct them to the ruins of the lost city.

The characters pursue a mysterious cult believed to be responsible for recent kidnappings in the region.

Quest: Weaken the cult of The Dark One by defeating Adamacles, the head priest who resides in the volcano, and discover the cult's occupation of Thracia. Regardless of the hook used, the characters should discover the threat presented by The Dark One's cult. Defeating the cult would go a long way to ensuring the security of settlements throughout the area.

THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA

This adventure takes place in the vicinity of *OAR #9: The Caverns of Thracia* and is intended as a prequel to that adventure. If you don't plan to run *OAR #9: The Caverns of Thracia*, references to that adventure can be removed or adjusted as needed. This might affect the choice of Adventure Hooks (see above) as well as the events detailed in the Concluding the Adventure section (see below).

SCALING THE ADVENTURE

The Sacrificial Pyre of Thracia is designed for four to six 1st-level characters but can be modified for parties of different sizes or levels. If the encounters are adjusted, don't forget to adjust the amount of treasure appropriately. Consider adapting the adventure as follows:

Weaker parties (3 or fewer characters):

- Reduce any Wandering Monster encounters of three or more creatures by one.
- Reduce the number of cultists in area 1-1 to match the number of characters.
- The *goodberries* the characters receive in area 1-2 are new and last 24 hours.
- Replace one thug in area 3-1 with a **guard**.
- The cult fanatic in area 3-3 doesn't have time to cast *shield of faith* before the characters enter.
- The force beam from the brazier in area 3-4 attacks with a +3 bonus.
- Reduce the number of bandits in area 3-5 to one.
- Reduce the number of zombies in area 3-6 to two.
- Replace one thug in area 3-8 with a **guard**.
- Reduce the number of bandits in area 3-9 to one.
- The otyugh in area 3-10 has 58 hit points and a walking speed of 20 feet.
- Reduce the number of zombies in area 3-11 to match the number of characters.
- Reduce the number of acolytes in area 3-13 to one.
- Reduce the number of acolytes in area 3-20 to match the number of characters.
- If there are less than three characters in area 3-23, reduce the number of smoke mephits to one.
- Reduce the number of magmins in area 3-24 to two and remove the saving throw for exhaustion.

Stronger parties (more than 6 characters and/or higher than 1st level):

- Increase the number of cultists in area 1-1 by one for every two characters in the party above six.
- Add one **guard** to area 3-1.
- In area 3-3, add one cultist for every two characters above six. The cult fanatic has time to cast *spiritual weapon* before the characters enter.
- The force beam from the brazier in area 3-4 attacks with a +6 bonus.
- In area 3-5, increase the number of bandits to three and the number of cultists to five.
- Increase the number of zombies in area 3-6 to four.
- Add one **guard** to area 3-8.
- In area 3-9, increase the number of bandits to three and the number of cultists to three.
- The otyugh in area 3-10 has 93 hit points.
- Increase the number of zombies in area 3-11 to six.
- Add two **cultists** to area 3-13 if there are eight or more characters or if the majority of characters are 2nd-level or higher.
- Replace the cultists in area 3-16 with **acolytes**.
- Add a **swarm of spiders** to area 3-17.
- If the characters attempt to remove the boots or excavate the body in area 3-18, they trigger another rockslide and must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw, taking 5 (1d10) bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. A character who examines the area before moving anything identifies this danger with a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Nature or Perception) check.
- Add two **zombies** to area 3-20.
- Add a **steam mephit** to area 3-23.
- The saving throws for exhaustion must be made every round starting on round 3.

THE LANGUAGE OF THRACIA

Modern Thracian is the most frequently spoken language in the region where this adventure takes place. However, many people also learn Common, or at least enough of it to get by. Modern Thracian may be considered an alternative human language and can be selected by characters who get to choose additional languages.

If, as GM, you believe the difficulty in communicating with the NPCs that primarily speak Modern Thracian might frustrate your players, you can always provide alternate means for dealing with it. The party can discover a dented and corroded *helm of comprehend languages* hidden among the vegetation along the eastward trail. Perhaps a merchant in Hamlet (see Part 1) offers to sell the characters *spell scrolls* of *comprehend languages* for 75 gp each before they depart for the volcano. The party could even find one or two such scrolls as treasure on the cultists in area 1-1. Finally, you can simply choose to replace references to Modern Thracian with Common if you wish.

BEGINNING THE ADVENTURE

The adventure begins with the characters heading south along a rough trail through a rainforest. Read or paraphrase the following, adjusting the text based on the specific adventure hook employed by the GM:

After wandering through this dense rainforest for what seems like hours, you come upon a well-traveled path of packed earth, too wide and worn to be a simple animal trail. You follow the trail east in hopes it will eventually lead to a village or other settlement. The cacophony of birds, insects, and tree frogs is so constant that it fades into the background, making the sounds of a struggle a short distance to the east draw your attention.

The characters are in the northwest corner of hex 0815 (see **Map 1**). If they investigate the sounds of struggle, continue to area 1-1 in Part 1.

PART 1: WELCOME TO THE JUNGLE...

GENERAL FEATURES

The region where this adventure takes place is fully depicted on **Maps 1 and 2**.

Climate. The climate of the region is subtropical with generally warm and moist weather. Winters are noticeably colder, but snow is rare. Forests consist of dense jungle, with some areas lacking vegetation on the forest floor due to sunlight being blocked out by a thick canopy. The water temperatures are comfortable enough for bathing and swimming most of the year. Warm air currents regularly move across the region from the southwest towards the northeast.

Geography. The settlement of Hamlet is surrounded by dense jungle on three sides, with a westward-flowing river to the south.

Overland Travel. In general, overland travel counts as moving through difficult terrain (see core rulebook). Exceptions include travel along roads (which typically consist of cobblestones) or maintained trails (typically consisting of cleared and packed earth), as well as within any organized settlement.

Ruins. Ancient buildings are constructed primarily of stone, including locally mined marble, and most seem structurally sound. Much of the wood used in the construction of doors, room partitions, and accents, however, has either rotted away completely or exhibits significant rot due to the humidity of the area. Any wooden structures that remain can be toppled or broken down with a successful DC 10 Strength check, unless specified otherwise in the area's description.

Trails. Several trails branch out from the settlement of Hamlet into the surrounding areas. These have been formed from the remains of ancient roads, regular animal travel, and the occasional bushwhacking of explorers heading to the settlement. Unlike the surrounding jungles, these trails, although not completely clear of plant growth and forest debris, don't count as difficult terrain.

Water Travel. Inland rivers are generally navigable by barges or smaller watercraft, although there are a few stretches that include rapids or waterfalls. Heading upstream to the east is difficult but not impossible.

Wildlife. Away from settled areas, the jungle is filled with wildlife including countless birds, reptiles, amphibians, and mammals. Many species of birds from northern climes migrate to the region and overwinter here. This information is known to any character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check.

WANDERING MONSTERS

Every time the characters travel through a jungle or trail hex, there is a 1 in 4 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll a d8 and consult the Jungle and Trail Travel table, below.

JUNGLE AND TRAIL TRAVEL

d8 roll	Encounter
1	Ankheg
2	Artifact of another age
3	Dog folk
4	Dust mephits
5	Gnoll patrol
6	Lizardfolk
7	Tiger
8	Undead swarm

JUNGLE AND TRAIL TRAVEL WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Ankheg. An **ankheg** bursts from the ground to attack the characters. If the characters are within a hex of the ruins (hex 1015), the tunnels left behind by the ankheg might lead there, if the GM wishes to develop that area. The creature doesn't pursue if the characters flee.

Artifact of Another Age. This worn and possibly damaged nonmagical artifact from ages past might be partially buried,

nestled among the roots of an ancient tree, or concealed by rocky terrain or high grass. Choose or randomly determine an item from the Trinkets table in the core rulebook or develop your own. Any writing on the item is in Ancient Thracian, the original written and spoken tongue of the Thracian people, now considered a dead language.

Dog Folk. Four **dogfolk** (see appendices A and B), each resembling a different breed of domesticated dog, excitedly but cautiously approach the characters. The dogfolk base their actions on the characters' reactions. They aren't affiliated with any groups or settlements in the area and survive as a "pack" just fine on their own. They don't accompany the characters on their adventures but might provide information or directions if treated well.

Dust Mephits. An unusual rocky outcropping is a trio of **dust mephits** who attack anyone that encroaches on their territory. If spoken to in Terran, the creatures immediately become friendly. The mephits might accompany the characters until they reach a desert or mountain hex, at which point they fly off to explore the area on their own.

Gnoll Patrol. A patrol of three **gnolls** scout the area. They attack any creatures they encounter that aren't dogfolk, gnolls, or lizardfolk, fighting to the death.

Lizardfolk. A group of four **lizardfolk** patrol the area. Instead of javelins, each lizardfolk carries four darts (*Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage). This encounter occurs only if the characters are within one hex of water (river, lake, swamp, etc.).

Tiger. A **tiger** lurks within the shrubs and foliage, waiting for prey to come within striking range. The creature loses interest and doesn't pursue characters who flee.

Undead Swarm. A weathered swarm of 1d4 **skeletons** and 1d4 **zombies** wanders randomly and moves to attack any creatures they notice. The skeletons are unarmed and attack with bites or claws as follows:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

In addition to their Slam attack, the zombies also have a Bite action:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

GM Note. Part 1 of this adventure takes place in the jungles depicted on **Map 1** and follows the most likely course of the characters' travel (through hexes 0815, 0916, 1016, and 1117). The GM is empowered to use the Wandering Monsters section (above) as well as their own imagination to populate any adjacent hexes the characters decide to wander through. The adventure starts on the northeastern part of hex 0815 and progresses to Part 2 once the characters reach the shared border of hexes 1117 and 1216.

AREA 1-1 – THE TRAIL

Use **Map 2** to depict the relative locations of areas 1-1 and 1-2 within the village of Hamlet.

Darting down the trail towards the sounds of commotion, you come upon its source. An unarmed man lies injured on the ground. A woman helps him to his feet while simultaneously fending off the attacks of several fighting men wielding scimitars.

The four fighting men are **cultists** of The Dark One. They speak and understand only Modern Thracian. The cultists are part of a small group who have just raided Hamlet and kidnapped several citizens to take away as sacrifices to their

dark god. The man and woman (unarmed **commoners** who speak Modern Thracian and some Common) managed to escape before being tracked down by the cultists.

When the characters appear, two of the cultists move to engage them while the other two hang back to subdue the commoners.

If the characters defeat the cultists, the commoners are extremely grateful and ask the characters to accompany them back to their settlement, which they refer to simply as "Hamlet." Along the short journey, the man (named Ekim) and woman (named Tena) explain that their attackers were cultists who likely raided their village to capture sacrifices for their deity. Both Ekim and Tena recognize the skull pendants worn by the cultists as symbols of the cult of The Dark One. If the characters left any of the cultists alive, the cultists confirm Ekim and Tena's suspicions, as they have no reason to hide anything.

Treasure. Each of the four cultists wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp each).

CULTIST TRAITS

Most cultists of The Dark One in this adventure wear a pendant with a silver skull charm with turquoise eyes. Although the pendant has no special properties, it is the standard symbol of faith for followers of The Dark One. Should the GM choose to run *OAR #9: The Caverns of Thracia* after this adventure, the characters will already be familiar with the symbol when they encounter it there.

Members of the cult also bear a small white skull tattoo on the back of their right hands. If the GM chooses to run *OAR #9: The Caverns of Thracia* after this adventure, the tattoo functions identically to the white, skull-shaped blemish mentioned in the upper levels of the caverns. Like the blemish, the tattoo can be removed with a combination of *remove curse* and *cure wounds* spells cast at 4th-level or higher.

Unless otherwise specified, members of the cult of The Dark One in this adventure are neutral evil and speak and read Modern Thracian as their default language.

AREA 1-2 – THE HAMLET

The jungle trail continues to the southeast before opening into a clearing with a massive firepit at its center. In addition to the huts at ground level, massive treehouses can be seen throughout the jungle canopy, with rope bridges strung between them acting as an elevated network of streets.

As you arrive, citizens wander the streets bearing weapons, while archers look down from the treehouses for any sign of the recent raiders. The incursion, however, seems to have ended. An older man, well beyond his prime years, calls out for the citizens' attention.

Show the illustrations on **Player Handout 1** for a representation of the treehouses. Ekim and Tena identify the elder gentleman as Sawik'it, their tribe's shaman. Treat Sawik'it as a **druid** with Charisma 14 (+2) who speaks Common, Druidic, and Modern Thracian. Sawik'it does his best to convince the citizens that the raid is over and that those left behind are now safe. While others call out about missing loved ones and the need to track down the kidnappers, Tena approaches Sawik'it to explain how the characters saved her and Ekim, as well as provide details about the pendants the invaders wore. Within a few minutes, Sawik'it requests Ekim, Tena, and the characters join him in his treehouse to discuss the matter further.

Sawik'it lives alone in a large treehouse by the trail south of the clearing and firepit. Access to the treehouse is via a rope ladder than can be pulled up and stored in the treehouse when visitors aren't expected.

If the characters accept Sawik'it's invitation and climb up to his treehouse (marked as 1-2 on **Map 2**), they are asked to sit on a patio overlooking the jungle. Sawik'it offers the characters an herbal tea (now lukewarm, as he was brewing it just as the raid occurred) and relates the following information before requesting the characters' assistance:

- Hamlet is a community of hunter-gatherers, with no real military to defend itself.
- The citizens are descendants of people from the ancient city of Thracia (as are the cultists).
- Thracia was abandoned centuries ago after it fell to invaders.
- Years ago, an expedition to the ancient city's ruins revealed it had been overrun by "beast men," so the majority of Thracian descendants decided to stay away. Sawik'it has no further information about the beast men.
- Several members of the expedition learned about The Dark One from writings left behind in the city's ruins and chose to resurrect The Dark One's cult.
- Adamacles, the leader of the expedition and once a respected elder, left Hamlet to found his own sect dedicated to The Dark One.
- The cult of The Dark One practices human sacrifice. There has been word of them raiding other communities within the jungle and capturing traveling merchants to utilize as sacrifices.
- Adamacles's cult resides within a "sleeping fire mountain" several miles to the east.

Sawik'it asks the characters if they would track down the cultists and rescue the kidnapped citizens. Sawik'it admits he has no right to ask, but Hamlet is not a community of adventurers, and the rare visitors who pass this way are typically merchants, who would be of little help in this matter.

If the characters agree to take on this task, Sawik'it promises to reward the characters when they return. If the characters ask what the reward will consist of, Sawik'it struggles to find the right word before replying simply "gold." A character who makes a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check determines that Sawik'it genuinely intends to reward the characters with something of value but might not know yet exactly what the reward will be.

Before the characters leave, Sawik'it summons several **acolytes** to heal any injured characters and presents the characters with four potions (see Treasure, below) and one *goodberry* each. Sawik'it tells the characters the *goodberries* are from a spell he cast late yesterday. He doesn't currently have the spell prepared for a new casting, but he claims the berries "should be good for a while." In game terms, the goodberries last for the duration of the adventure or until the characters finish a long rest, whichever comes first. Sawik'it also casts *druidcraft* to provide the characters insight into the next 24 hours' weather (clear with no precipitation).

As the characters prepare to leave, Sawik'it provides the following directions to the "sleeping fire mountain" (also see **Player Handout 2**):

"*Follow the trail south of us along the river to the east until you reach the mountains. Then head north, keeping the mountains to your right. You will eventually come to a desert. Continue to keep the mountains on your right until you find the broken mountain. This is the sleeping fire mountain. Those that worship The Dark One live inside the mountain. That's where they have taken our people.*"

If the characters need supplies before leaving Hamlet, they can purchase any adventuring gear, armor, tools, or weapons in the core rulebook with a cost of less than 50 gp.

Treasure. If the characters agree to take on Sawik'it's mission, he presents the party with three *potions of healing* and a *potion of fire resistance*.

FOLLOWING THE ROAD

With Sawik'it's directions, the characters find the trail east easy to follow. For most of the journey, they need only follow the trail and keep the river to their right. There are a few stretches, however, where the road drifts beyond sight of the river or gets lost in the undergrowth. Progressing from one hex to another without incident (excluding the possibility of a random Wandering Monster encounter as detailed above) requires a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check performed by the character selected to serve as the party's guide. On a failed check, the character must attempt a second DC 15 Wisdom (Survival) check. If this check also fails, the characters automatically have a Wandering Monster encounter in that hex: roll 1d8 on the Jungle and Trail Travel table above. Note that this Wandering Monster encounter is in addition to the random one which may or may not occur in each hex.

Another character can serve as a secondary guide for the journey, granting the primary guide advantage on their Wisdom (Survival) checks.

AREA 1-3 – A GLIMPSE OF THE WASTELAND

The trail east of Hamlet gradually turns south during the first mile outside of the settlement. For the most part, your path hugs the northern shore of a westward-flowing river, with some minor detours due to erosion near the water's edge. The far side of the river, to the south, lies in stark contrast to the lush jungle on your side. Numerous boulders, rocky outcroppings, and noticeably less vegetation cover the inhospitable landscape as far as one can see.

Characters who search for tracks left behind by the cultists and their victims and succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check can confirm that a large group of humanoids recently passed along the trail, headed east.

AREA 1-4 – THE RIVER'S SOURCE

Roughly two miles east of Hamlet, you discover the source of the river your trail has followed. The lake from which the river is born stretches to the east and south nearly as far as the eye can see in both directions. From this point, the ancient road serving as the foundation for the trail you follow peeks out from the overgrowth, continuing east along the lake's northern shore.

Characters who search for traces of the cultists and their victims and succeed on a DC 20 Wisdom (Survival) check find occasional signs of a large party of humanoids passing this way.

AREA 1-5 – THE ROAD LESS TRAVELED

Stepping out of the jungle, you find yourself at the foot of a range of mountains stretching to the northeast. Ahead, the broken trail you've been following winds between the mountains to the north and the swampy shore of a lake to the south.

Based on Sawik'it's directions, it should be obvious to the characters that this is where they must leave the trail and head northeast along the edge of the mountains. If none of the players realize this, allow the guide to make a DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check or any other character to make DC 10 Intelligence check to remember Sawik'it's instructions.

If the characters continue to follow the trail, they cross hex 1216 (possibly having additional Wandering Monster encounters; see above) before they realize their mistake and are forced to backtrack (or cut north).

Characters who search for tracks fail to find any; the cultists directed their prisoners along a slightly different path, cutting through the jungle in hex 1116 to reach the mountains.

Once the characters proceed east from this location, continue to hex 1216 in Part 2.

PART 2: BETWEEN A ROCK AND A HOT PLACE

GENERAL FEATURES

The region where this adventure takes place is fully depicted on **Map 1**.

Climate. The climate of this area varies greatly, from the generally cool elevations of the mountains to the striking contrasts of the desert, which are hot during the day and cold at night. Warm air currents regularly move across the region from the southwest towards the northeast, where they are dispersed by the western mountain faces.

Geography. A short expanse of desert separates the jungles to the west from the mountain range and (extinct? dormant?) volcano in the east.

Illumination. Daylight comes late to the land immediately west of the mountains, as the peaks block out the sun for nearly an hour after sunrise.

Overland Travel. In general, overland travel counts as moving through difficult terrain (see the core rulebook). Exceptions include travel along roads (which typically consist of cobblestones) or maintained trails (typically consisting of cleared and packed earth). Travel between hexes 1316 and 1415 isn't difficult terrain, as an ancient, solidified lava flow essentially functions as a paved road.

Trails. There are no established trails between the desert and mountains, but an ancient, solidified lava flow functions as a paved road connecting hexes 1316 and 1415.

Wildlife. The desert is devoid of wildlife, except for burrowing creatures near the jungle and mountain borders and the occasional wandering monster. Several species of insects, raptors, reptiles, rodents, and large predatory mammals make the mountains their home. This information is known to any character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check.

WANDERING MONSTERS

Each time the characters travel through a desert or mountain hex, there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll a d8 and consult the Desert and Mountain Travel table, below.

DESERT AND MOUNTAIN TRAVEL

d8 roll	Encounter
1	Cultists of The Dark One
2	Dust mephits
3	Fast zombies
4	Gnoll patrol
5	Minotaur
6	Not quite a real snake
7	Satyrs
8	Svirfneblin explorers

DESERT AND MOUNTAIN TRAVEL WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Cultists of The Dark One. Two **cultists** and one **cult fanatic** have hung back in case any residents from Hamlet have pursued the kidnappers. They fight to the death. Each of them wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

Dust Mephits. A trio of **dust mephits** attempt to ambush the characters, opening with their Blinding Breath actions.

Fast Zombies. A cluster of 1d4 + 1 desiccated but startlingly quick **zombies** attack any creatures they notice. The zombies have a speed of 30 feet and a Bite attack in addition to their Slam attack:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

Gnoll Patrol. A patrol of three **gnolls** scout the area. They attack any creatures they encounter that aren't dogfolk, gnolls, or lizardfolk, fighting to the death.

Minotaur. A single **minotaur** outcast from the caverns below Thracia wanders the area in search of food and shelter.

Not Quite a Real Snake. The characters unwittingly disturb the den of a **phorcides' follicle** (see appendix B), which attacks to defend its home from intruders. If the characters leave it alone, the creature doesn't pursue them.

Satyrs. A pair of **satyrs** are openly curious about the characters and, at the GM's discretion, might share useful information in exchange for wine, a song, or dancing.

Svirfneblin Explorers. A group of six **svirfneblin** explorers surveys the area in search of an abandoned marble quarry. If asked for directions to the volcano, the deep gnomes happily supply such information, even pointing out the peak in the distance if it's close enough to be visible. They don't have any idea what, if anything, might be found in the volcano.

GM Note. Part 2 of this adventure takes place along the desert and mountain areas depicted on **Map 1** and follows the most likely course of the characters' travel (through hexes 1216, 1316, and 1415). The GM is empowered to use the Wandering Monsters section (above) as well as their own imagination to populate any adjacent hexes the characters decide to wander through. This part of the adventure starts in hex 1216 (area 2-1) and progresses to Part 3 once the characters reach the volcano in hex 1415.

AREA 2-1 – THE WALL IN THE JUNGLE

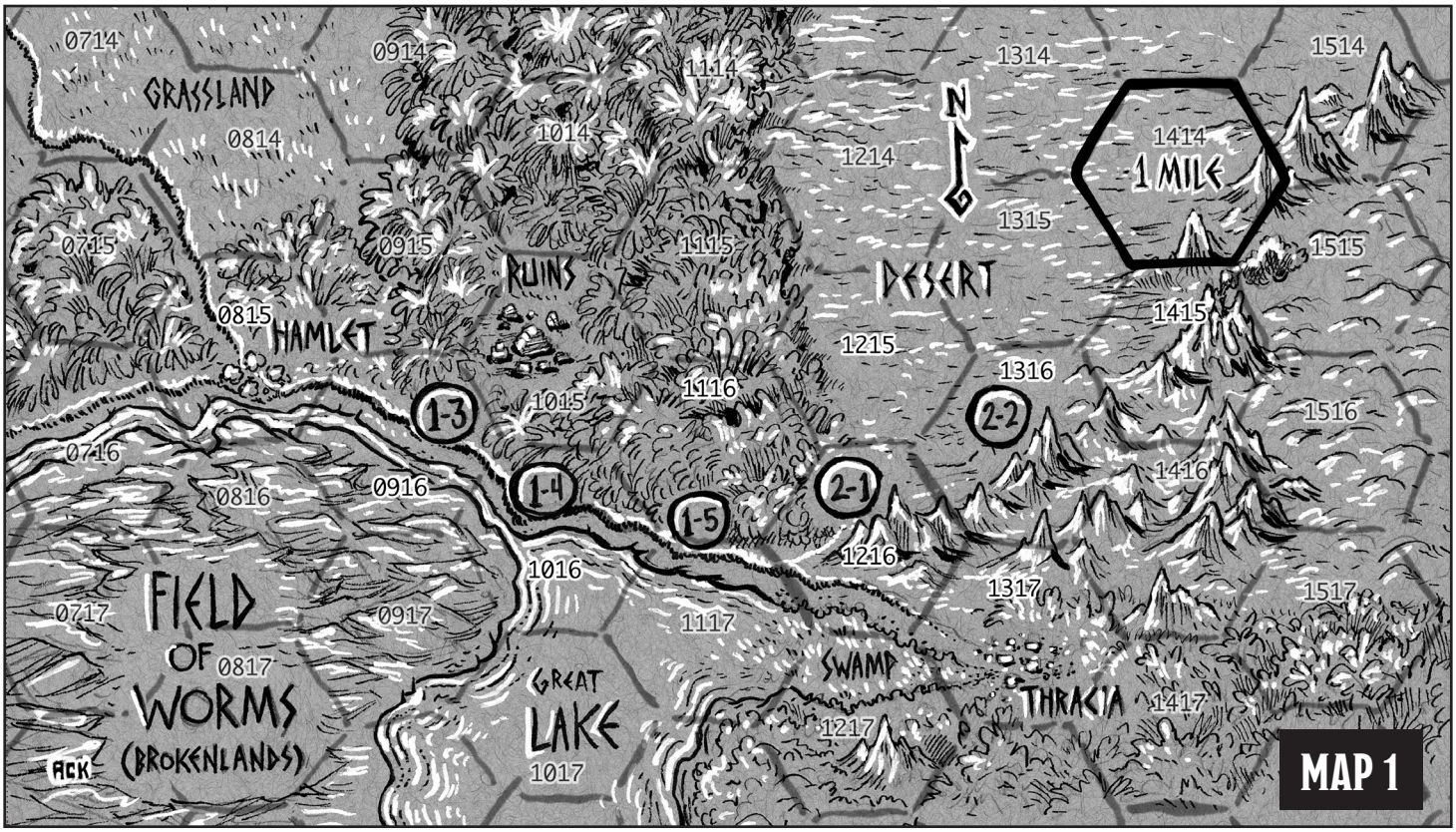
A wall of mountains rises from the jungle to the east, making off-trail travel in that direction difficult. A mile to the north, the jungle gives way to an expanse of desert. The mountains, however, continue to run to the northeast as far as you can see.

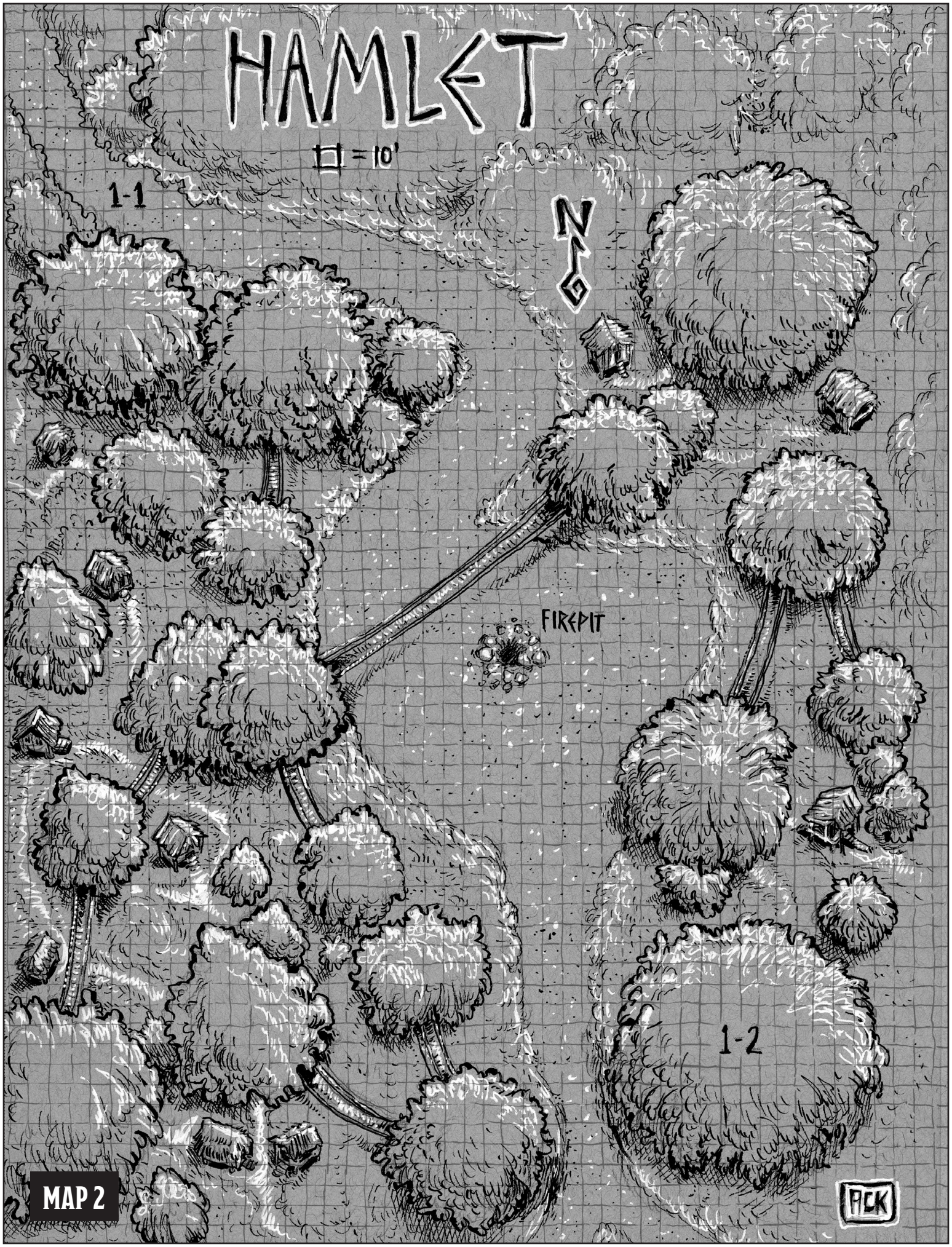
If the characters follow Sawik'it's suggestion and travel north in the shadow of the mountains, they will be fine. If they strike into the desert, each character must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw for each mile traveled during the day (or each desert hex crossed) or suffer a level of exhaustion from the intense heat.

TRAVELING THE EDGE

Following the desert northeast within the shadows of the mountains, per Sawik'it's instructions, is an easy task. If the characters head into the mountains prematurely, however, they risk becoming lost. Progressing from one hex to another without incident (excluding the possibility for a random Wandering Monster encounter as detailed above) requires a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check performed by the character selected to serve as the group's guide. On a failure, the characters have inadvertently drifted too far into the mountains and have difficulty getting back on track. With a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Survival) check, they can find their way back to the edge of the desert. On a failure, they find their way back but automatically have a Wandering Monster encounter in that hex: roll 1d8 on the Desert and Mountain Travel table above. Note that this Wandering Monster encounter is in addition to the random one which may or may not occur in each hex.

Another character can serve as a secondary guide, granting the primary guide advantage on their Wisdom (Survival) checks.




HAMLET
□ = 10'
1-1
N
FIREPIT
1-2
MAP 2
PCK

AREA 2-2 – THE VIEW

From atop a rocky outcropping where the desert meets the western edge of the mountains, you survey the surrounding lands. To the northwest, the desert stretches for several miles before the green line of the horizon indicates the beginning of the jungle. To the east, the mountains eventually give way to smaller foothills before the landscape once again blends into jungle. To the north and northeast, mountains stretch on as far as the horizon. Roughly a mile to the northeast, the time-weathered remains of a large crater can be discerned among the taller surrounding peaks. This is likely the remains of the ancient volcano Sawik'it told you to seek.

Once the characters leave this area and arrive in hex 1415, proceed to Part 3.

PART 3: TUBESPACE

GENERAL FEATURES

The region where this adventure takes place is fully depicted on **Map 3**.

Climate. The area around the volcano is markedly warmer than the rest of the mountain area, with the temperature immediately outside the volcano being comfortably warm and the temperature within the lava tubes noticeably hotter.

Doors. Most rooms within the lava tubes don't have doors. If they do, the doors are usually poorly constructed of wood (AC 15; 27 hit points; immunity to necrotic, poison, and psychic damage). Locked doors can be unlocked with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

Geology. The caverns within the volcano are geological formations known as lava tubes. As the surface of these ancient lava flows cooled, the lava inside flowed out, leaving behind hollow tubes. The tubes are composed of black basalt striped with ribbons of red, orange, and purple. These colorful ribbons aren't veins of valuable minerals, but simply the result of mineral contaminants present when the tubes solidified. The lava tubes are typically 10 feet in diameter, although larger chambers, where lava collected before flowing away, can be found throughout the underground network. A character can identify the nature of the lava tubes with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check.

Illumination. The tunnels inside the volcano are illuminat-

ed by torches set in wall sconces every 40 feet. To keep from drawing unwanted attention, no torches are placed within 40 feet of any entrance. Areas not occupied by the cult also lack torches.

Overland Travel. Travel within hex 1415 isn't considered difficult terrain, as the ancient, solidified lava flows act like paved roads leading directly to the base of the volcano.

Wildlife. A character who succeeds on a DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check knows that several species of insects, raptors, reptiles, rodents, and large predatory mammals make the mountains their home. Characters interested in birdwatching can attempt a DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) or Intelligence (Nature) check. On a success, the character spots various raptors on high perches, looking for their next meals.

WANDERING MONSTERS

Every 10 minutes the characters spend wandering the corridors within the volcano, there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll a d6 and consult the Volcano Travel table, below.

VOLCANO TRAVEL

d8 roll	Encounter
1	Acolyte pair
2	Cultist pair
3	Escaped prisoner
4	Guard patrol
5	Hungry, hungry zombies
6	Magma mephit

VOLCANO TRAVEL WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Acolyte Pair. Two **acolytes** return from a meeting and discuss another settlement called "Thracia." Each of them wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

Cultist Pair. Two **cultists** head to their barracks for some down time. Each of them wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

Escaped Prisoner. Against the better judgment of his companions, a male, unarmed **commoner** has managed to escape and is making a break for freedom. He speaks Modern Thracian and some Common. If the characters convince him they aren't part of the cult, the man can lead the characters to where the other prisoners are kept (see area 3-7).

Guard Patrol. A trio of **guards** patrol the area for any escaped prisoners or wandering mephits. Each of them wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

Hungry, Hungry Zombies. A pair of startlingly quick **zombies** attack creatures not wearing a silver skull pendant. The zombies have a speed of 30 feet and have a Bite attack in addition to their Slam attack:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

Magma Mephit. A single **magma mephit** explores the caverns on his own, attempting to learn where the cultists of The Dark One congregate and what areas they tend to avoid.

AREA 3-1 – GUARD POST

Characters who approach this area from the outside and succeed on a DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check recognize the caldera as an earmark of a collapsed volcano. When the characters approach the entrance to the lava tube, read the following:

A natural stone cavern opens into the side of the ancient mountain. The entrance is dark and appears unguarded.

If the characters are already within the lava tubes as they approach this location, read the following:

The far end of this lava tube opens onto the volcano's exterior. Between you and the exit, however, stand two armed guards clad in leather armor.

The two guards are **thugs**. Unless alerted to intruders, their focus is on threats arriving from outside the volcano.

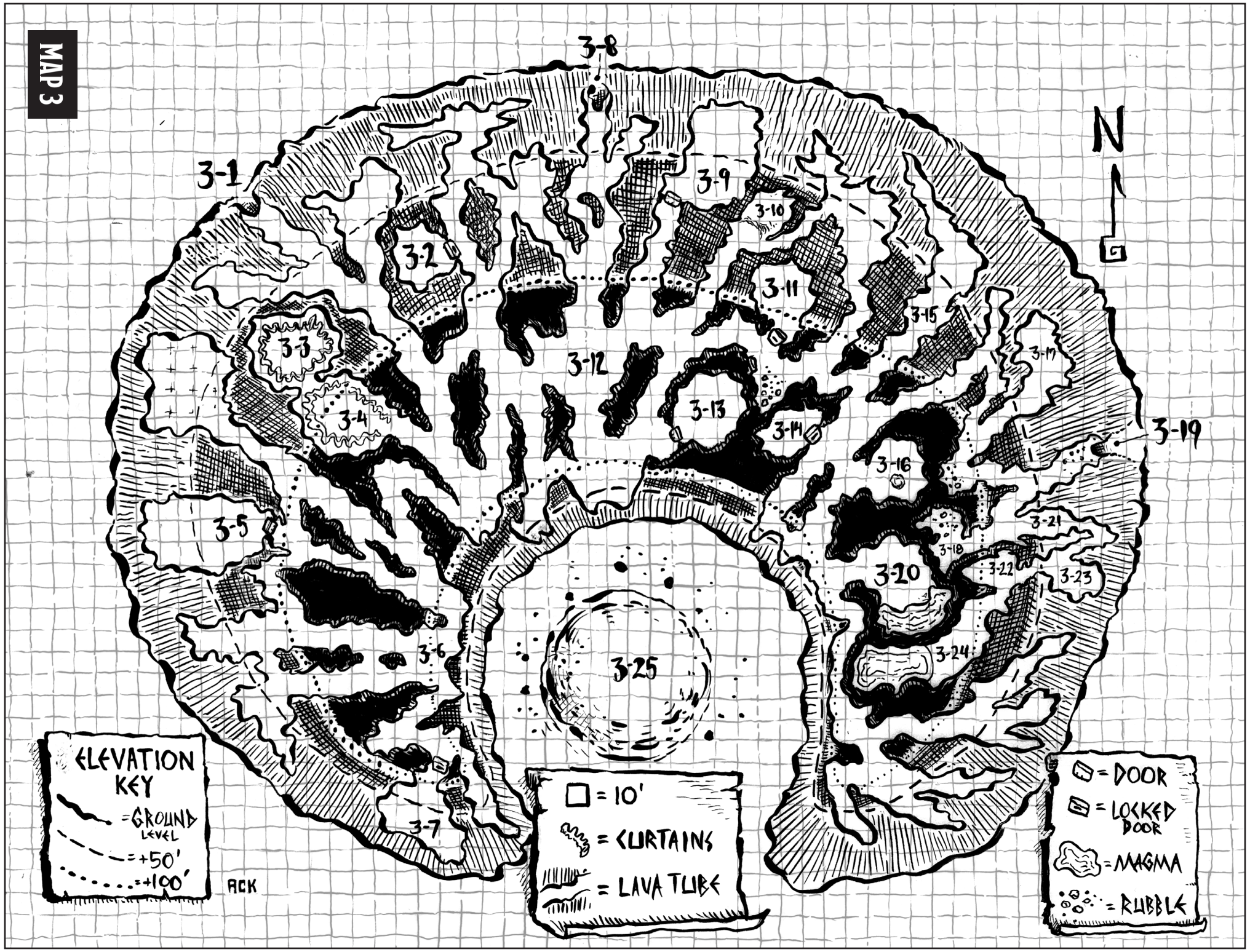
Treasure. Each of the thugs wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp each).

AREA 3-2 – TATTOO PARLOR

This room lies behind a locked wooden door. A character who makes a successful DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check hears something shuffling beyond the door. Adamacles (see appendix B and area 3-13) carries the key to this room.

An old, balding man with a long white beard sits quietly in one of two simple wooden chairs located in the middle of this room. On a small table beside the man sits a collection of pens and needles, as well as an inkwell containing what appears to be milk. The man is obviously awake but seems unaware of your presence.

The man is an unarmed, noncombatant **commoner**. Both blind and mute, he waits patiently for newly recruited cultists to come and receive a small white tattoo of a skull on the back of their right hands, a symbol of their membership


MAP 3
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ELEVATION KEY
=GROUND LEVEL
=+50'
=+100'
ACK
= 10'
= CURTAINS
= LAVA TUBE
= DOOR
= LOCKED DOOR
= MAGMA
= RUBBLE

in the cult. A character who makes a successful DC 8 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Medicine or Perception) check deduces that the man's milky white eyes indicate he is completely blind. If the characters enter the room without sneaking, the old man hears them and motions for them to sit next to him. If any character accepts the invitation, the man tattoos a small white skull on the back of their right hand. Although blind, the man works with great skill: the emblem is easily recognizable and, if granted to several characters, consistent in appearance. See the Cultist Traits sidebar in Part 1.

The man doesn't bear a tattoo himself and is hesitant to leave the chamber, although he won't fight if forced to leave.

AREA 3-3 – THE TEMPLE

The walls of this room are draped with thick, black curtains from floor to ceiling. A cloaked individual lights a stick of incense from a small brazier. Next to the brazier stands an altar supporting a wooden statue of a cloaked figure with a skull for a face.

If the characters revealed their presence in area 3-4 (by triggering the brazier trap, for example), the **cult fanatic** expects them and has already cast *shield of faith* on himself (increasing his AC to 15). The cultist speaks only Modern Thracian.

The characters can surprise the cult fanatic by succeeding on a group DC 11 Dexterity (Stealth) check. The fanatic is outraged by the characters' trespass into this holy sanctum and fights to the death.

Treasure. The cult fanatic wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp) and carries a *potion of diminution*.

AREA 3-4 – PREPARATION CHAMBER

The perimeter of this chamber is draped with thick, black curtains from floor to ceiling. A single brazier in the center of the room bathes the area in bright light. Next to the brazier, a wooden stand supports a wash basin and a ceramic pitcher. Across the room, an overlapping section of curtains gives the impression that another chamber lies beyond them.

This room is a preparation chamber, where followers of The Dark One are expected to perform a ritual cleansing by washing their face and hands using the pitcher and basin. The bottom of the basin is painted with an image of a skull similar in design to that of the pendants worn by the cultists. Water poured from the pitcher becomes contaminated once it enters the basin. Although the water can be used to wash without any ill effects, anyone who drinks directly from the basin takes 5 (1d10) necrotic damage and must succeed on a DC 11 Constitution saving throw or be poisoned for 1 hour.

Treasure. The pitcher functions as a *decanter of endless water*. The basin would be of interest to a collector of religious or historical items and could fetch 50 gp if sold in a city. The basin loses its ability to contaminate water once it is removed from this chamber.

Development. If parted, the overlapping curtains reveal the temple beyond (see area 3-3). If a character parts the curtains without first washing using the pitcher and basin, a beam of energy fires from the brazier towards the character (+5 to hit; 1d10 force damage on a successful hit). The brazier and basin effects are both magical in nature and can't be detected by mundane means.

AREA 3-5 – THE BARRACKS

This room lies behind a closed wooden door without a lock. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check hears low, indiscernible voices on the other side of the door.

This room contains two rows of cots, giving the impression of extremely spartan living quarters for a small group. Several individuals clad in robes and armor are present when you peer into the room.

The six individuals are four **cultists** and two **bandits**. They attack anyone not visibly wearing a silver skull pendant like those worn by other cult members.

Treasure. Each of the six cult members wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). One of them also carries a set of thieves' tools (worth 25 gp). One of the bandits carries a key to the pantry (area 3-14).

Development. If the characters kill two or more of the cultists, one of the cultists heads to area 3-9 or 3-13 to alert the individuals there.

AREA 3-6 – RECYCLED HELP

A group of humanoids rush down the hallway in your direction. They appear unarmed, but each emits a low, rumbling growl in an eerie chorus.

The creatures are three **zombies** with a speed of 30 feet and a Bite attack in addition to their Slam attack:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

GM Note. A wound from the zombies' Bite attack remains swollen for 24 to 48 hours afterwards, even after being healed. The effect is harmless, but the GM may call for the occasional Constitution saving throw to heighten the players' paranoia about the injury.

AREA 3-7 – THE PRISON

A series of vertical steel bars embedded in the black basalt of the cavern prevents further access to this chamber. A similarly constructed door housing a large lock mechanism traps eight or so figures on the opposite side of the bars. From the nervous looks and style of dress worn by the prisoners, you believe you've found the missing citizens of Hamlet.

Inside the cell are eight unarmed **commoners** (all of whom speak Modern Thracian and some Common), all recently kidnapped from Hamlet. The door to the cell is locked. A shielded lock on the cell door prevents those inside the cell from being able to access the internal mechanism. One of the acolytes in area 3-20 has the key. Opening the lock without the key requires thieves' tools and a successful DC 18 Dexterity check. The lock can also be destroyed (AC 19; 18 hit points; immunity to necrotic, poison, and psychic damage).

If rescued, the prisoners explain (using broken Common, if necessary) that a group of cultists recently took away two of their number, but they don't know where they were taken (see area 3-20). They are also aware of any escaped prisoners already encountered by the characters as part of the Wandering Monster encounters (see above).

AREA 3-8 – SECOND GUARD POST

Characters who approach this area from the outside and succeed on a DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check recognize the caldera as an earmark of a collapsed volcano. When the characters approach the entrance to the lava tube, read the following:

A natural stone cavern opens into the side of the ancient mountain. The entrance is dark and appears unguarded.

If the characters are already within the lava tube caverns as they approach this location, read the following:

The far end of this lava tube opens onto the volcano's exterior. Between you and the exit, however, stand two armed guards clad in leather armor.

The two guards are **thugs**. Unless alerted to intruders, their focus is on threats arriving from outside the volcano.

Treasure. Each of the thugs wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

AREA 3-9 – THE OTHER BARRACKS

This room lies behind a closed wooden door without a lock. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Percep-

tion) check hears low, indiscernible voices on the other side of the door.

This room contains two rows of cots, giving the impression of a basic dormitory for a small group. Several individuals clad in robes and armor are present in the room.

There are two **bandits**, two **cultists**, and two **tribal warriors** in the room. They attack anyone not wearing a silver skull pendant like those worn by other cult members.

Treasure. Each of the six cult members wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). One of the bandits carries a key to the pantry (area 3-14).

Development. If the characters kill two or more cultists, one of the cultists heads to area 3-5 or 3-13 and alerts the individuals there.

AREA 3-10 – THE DUMP

The corridor ends at an abrupt drop-off. A mound of debris sits about 20 feet below the edge. The unpleasant scent of rots wafts up from below, assaulting your nostrils.

The cult uses this area to dispose of trash. An **otyugh** lives at the bottom of the pit, subsisting on whatever trash the cultists literally toss its way. Due to a fractured leg, the otyugh has 78 hit points and a walking speed of 25 feet. If a character descends into the pit, the otyugh uses its Limited Telepathy trait to communicate that it is injured and wants to be freed. To assist the creature, a character must succeed on a DC 12 Charisma (Persuasion) check or find another way of peacefully conveying their intent. The characters must then either succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom (Medicine) check or use healing magic to treat the otyugh's injured leg. If successful, the creature becomes friendly and doesn't attack the characters. If the characters improvise a way to free the otyugh from the pit (it is 20 feet from the ground level to the lava tube), the creature is grateful and heads on its way, leaving the lava tubes as quickly as possible. It doesn't join the party on their exploration or fight cultists on the characters' behalf. There is always the chance, however, that the characters might encounter the creature again, should they continue to explore the region around Hamlet and Thracia.

Treasure. If any cult members happen upon this area (see Development, below), each wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

Development. If the characters spend the time to come up with a creative way to free the otyugh, a pair of **thugs** arrive to dispose of trash just as the creature is freed.

AREA 3-11 – THE TREASURY

This room lies behind a locked wooden door. Adamacles (see appendix B and area 3-13) carries the key. The room itself is silent.

Several stuffed sacks, an assortment of odd trinkets, and a rolled-up rug are stacked against one wall of this storage room. The most interesting feature of the space, however, are the figures dressed in ragged clothing standing motionless in the center of the room.

This room contains the cult's treasury of coins, gems, artwork…and undead servants. The four initially unmoving figures are **zombies**. The zombies have a speed of 30 feet and a Bite attack in addition to their Slam attack:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

Adamacles (see appendix B), the head priest of the cult, has been experimenting with the *animate dead* spell. All the undead creatures encountered in this adventure are his creations. After animating several zombies to serve as laborers for the cult, Adamacles discovered his zombies moved noticeably faster than expected and had a tendency to bite their targets. Without any other explanation, Adamacles attributed these additional traits as gifts from The Dark One. The zombies are kept out of the way when they aren't needed, stored in this room alongside the cult's other assets.

Treasure. The cult's wealth includes 1,100 cp, 400 sp, three art objects (a bronze crown, a collection of figurines carved from turquoise, and a large tapestry depicting the ancient city of Thracia, each worth 25 gp), three gems (a bloodstone, a blue jasper, and a banded onyx, each worth 50 gp), a set of *bracers of archery*, and a *periapt of health*.

GM Note. A wound from the zombies' Bite attack remains swollen for 24 to 48 hours afterwards, even after being healed. The effect is harmless, but the GM may call for the occasional Constitution saving throw to heighten the players' paranoia about the injury.

AREA 3-12 – THE DOG PARK

Four humanoids sit on the floor in the middle of this intersection, eating what appears to be a roasted game bird. Their attention shifts to you as you approach. Although human in stature, each has a head resembling a different type of domesticated canine.

The four creatures are **dogfolk** (N males and females; see appendix B). Although they aren't cultists, each wears a silver and turquoise pendant like the other cultists here. The dogfolk accidentally discovered the cult's lair and, seeing as they were nonaggressive, the cultists allowed the dogfolk to stay,

even giving them pendants so they wouldn't be harassed by the undead that wander the passages.

Unless attacked, the dogfolk are friendly to anyone they encounter. They have no affection for the cultists but have accepted their presence after being allowed to stay in the caverns. If befriended, the dogfolk answer any questions put to them as best that they can. Use the following information to answer any questions the characters ask the dogfolk.

- The dogfolk lived in the mountains before they discovered these caves.
- The people already living in the caves were nice enough to feed them and let them stay.
- They were given the "silver collars" and told to always wear them.
- They don't know how many people live here, but it's a lot.
- There are undead in the caverns, but the dogfolk avoid them because they smell.
- They don't know where the prisoners are.
- Adamacles is the "alpha" of the cult, but the dogfolk don't know where he is.
- They saw a small flying creature in the caverns but don't know what it was.
- If asked where treasure is kept, the dogfolk direct characters to the pantry (area 3-14).
- The dogfolk are familiar with areas 3-1 through 3-5 and areas 3-8 through 3-16 but haven't explored beyond that.
- The dogfolk will not join the characters (they're quite happy left to their own devices), nor do they help the characters defeat the cultists.

Treasure. Each of the dogfolk wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

AREA 3-13 – THE PRIEST'S QUARTERS

This room lies behind a closed wooden door. The door has a lock but is currently unlocked. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check hears low, indiscernible voices on the other side of the door.

This large chamber appears to serve as someone's private quarters. A bed, nightstand, desk, three chairs, and a small bookshelf fill out the room. Three robed figures stand by the desk.

These are the private quarters of the cult's leader and head priest, **Adamacles** (see appendix B). He and two **acolytes** discuss (in Modern Thracian) plans to abandon their volcano stronghold and move to the caverns below Thracia to join others are already based there.

Treasure. Each of the cultists wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). The books on the bookshelf are on Thracian history and may worth up to 50 gp to a collector in a large city. Adamacles wears a *cloak of protection*. On his desk are a collection of notes indicating that the cult plans to move its base of operations to the ruins of Thracia. Among the papers is a copy of **Maps 1** and **4** marked with access points to the caverns below the city (locations A and B on **Map 4**).

AREA 3-14 – THE PANTRY

This room lies behind a locked wooden door. Adamacles (see appendix B and area 3-13) and several other cultists carry keys to this room. The room itself is silent.

Various barrels, sacks, crates, and kegs are stacked high along both sides of this chamber, leaving only a narrow space to squeeze down its length.

The cultists use this area to store various foodstuffs and equipment. If the characters open any of the containers, consult the corresponding table below to determine its contents.

d8	Barrel or Keg Contents	Maximum Number
1	Beer or mead of low quality	8
2	Oil	5
3	Potable water	25
4	Wine (common)	10
5	Arrows (20)	4
6	Spears (10)	4
7	Crossbow bolts (20)	4
8	Honey	2

d8	Crate Contents	Maximum Number
1	Dried vegetables	5
2	Dried fruits	2
3	Meat jerky	4
4	Dried bread/biscuits/crackers	3
5	Various handheld tools	1
6	Cultist robes (6)	1
7	Ropes and chains	2
8	Boots and shoes of various sizes	1

d8	Sack Contents	Maximum Number
1	Ash	2
2	Bonemeal	1
3	Flour	4
4	Salt	4
5	Sugar	5
6	Talcum	1

Treasure. If any cult members happen upon this area (see Development, below), each wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). The bandit also carries a key to this chamber.

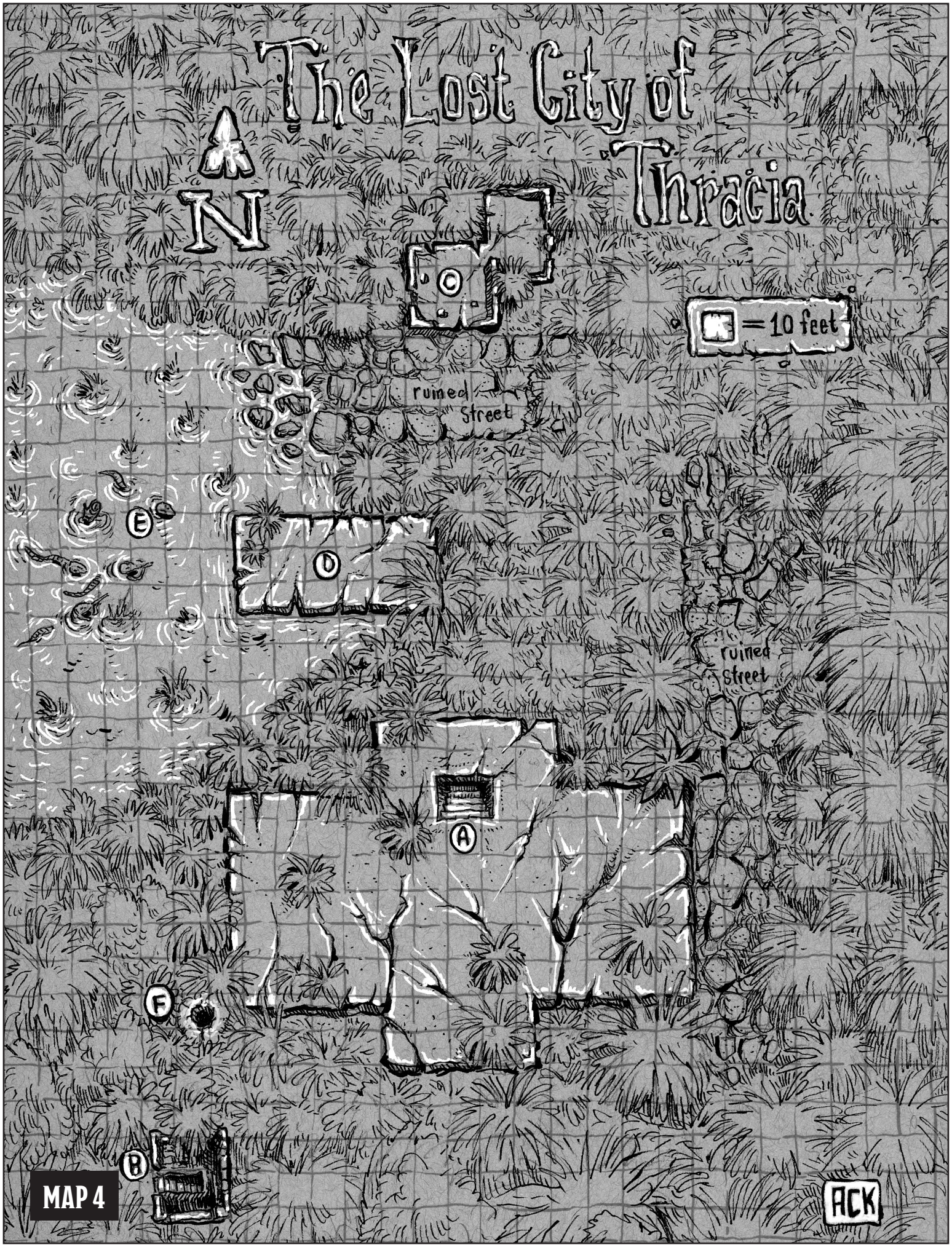
Development. A character who makes a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check deduces this is a high-traffic area and it is perhaps wise not to linger. If the characters spend an excessive amount of time opening containers, a **bandit**, a **cultist**, and a **guard** (all humans who speak and understand only Modern Thracian) stop by to gather supplies.

AREA 3-15 – THE ENEMY OF MY ENEMY

A trio of small, orange creatures fly slowly in your direction, sparks popping from their bodies as they move. The three seem to assess you for a moment.

Unless the characters are disguised as cultists or prisoners, read the following additional passage:

One of the creatures addresses your group: "You don't look like culters…but you have weapons, so not prisoners…so…why you in our caves?"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MAP 4
ACK

The three creatures are **magma mephits**. One of them, named Melt, is notably smarter than the others. He has Intelligence 12 (+1) and has managed to pick up some Common and Modern Thracian from studying a book stolen from the cultists (see area 3-22). If disguised as cultists, the characters can attempt a group DC 10 Charisma (Deception) check. On a failed check, the mephits see through the ruse. The mephits consider the lava tubes to be their domain and, although evil, would happily deal with anyone looking to evict the cult from their home.

If the mephits believe the characters are escaped prisoners, they offer to lead the characters to the closest exit and assist them in defeating any guards posted there (anything that inconveniences the cult serves their interests).

If the mephits believe the characters are cultists, or if the characters attack the mephits, one casts *heat metal* on a character wearing metal armor, while the others open with their Fire Breath action. If outnumbered, the mephits scatter into the tunnels after their initial attack.

If the characters indicate they are here to rescue the prisoners or to defeat the cult, the mephits try to strike a deal. If the characters promise to clear the tunnels of the cultists (or at least their leader in area 3-13 and most of the cultists in barracks areas 3-5 and 3-9), the mephits offer to lead the characters to the prisoners, so that the characters can lead them out and leave the mephits in peace. If the characters agree, the mephits lead them to areas 3-9, 3-13, and 3-5 (in that order) before escorting them to the prisoners in area 3-8. The mephits even assist the characters in ranged combat against any cult members they encounter, but they don't close in for melee.

AREA 3-16 – THE OVEN

This room is noticeably hotter than most of the caverns. It is furnished with a large stone table, a well approximately five feet in diameter, and a winch mechanism hanging from the ceiling above the well. A large, nasty-looking hook dangles from the winch's chain. Several empty cages of various sizes lie haphazardly about the room.

Although it might appear at first to be a torture chamber, this room serves as the cult's kitchen. A character who peers down the well sees the unmistakable glow of magma deep below. The cultists prepare their food by either attaching it to the hook (in the case of a large animal carcass) or placing it in a cage (for smaller meals) and then attaching the cage to the hook. The winch mechanism allows the chain to be lowered into the well so that the food can be "cooked" by the heat of the magma flow below. If the characters operate the winch, they find several links painted with different colors along the length of the chain as it unwinds. The links represent different cooking times and temperatures for various foodstuffs. The cultists who handle the cooking have memorized the meanings of the painted links ("lower a side of beef to the yellow link for 30 minutes to cook it, but only to the blue link and for 4 hours if you want to dry it out for jerky").

Treasure. If the cultists (see Development, below) enter the room, they each wear a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

Development. If the characters spend more than 10 minutes exploring the room, two **cultists** (who speak only Modern Thracian) arrive to cook a recently cleaned game bird.

AREA 3-17 – NOT SO ITSY BITSY

The ground in this corridor is covered in rocky debris and seems less frequently traveled than other passages inside the mountain. Stalactites hang from the ceiling, making the tunnel feel more closed in than the rest of the underground network.

A character who succeeds on a DC 20 Intelligence (Nature) check realizes that the "stalactites" are the webbed-up remains of prey captured by the **giant spider** that lives in this passage. The creature remains motionless as the characters approach. A character who succeeds on a DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check notices the creature. Once the characters have moved within range, the creature attacks.

AREA 3-18 – ROCKSLIDE

This corridor grows uncomfortably narrow along its length until ending abruptly at a cave in. Basalt boulders fill the end of the passage and spill back into the corridor another ten feet or so. A pair of boots stick out from beneath the debris.

The boots are all that remain of a cultist killed by a cave in. A character who examines or attempts to retrieve the boots discovers the previous owner's remains. A character who makes a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Medicine) check determines that the cultist died quite recently, likely within the past day.

If the characters attempt to extricate the remains (necessary to recover the silver chain mentioned in Treasure, below), they disturb a **phorcides' follicle** (see appendix B). The follicle was injured in the rockslide and now hides amongst the scree. Currently, the creature has 25 hit points and attacks only to defend itself. It doesn't pursue characters who leave the area and, given the opportunity, would prefer to slither beneath the debris than fight.

Treasure. The boots are a pair of *boots of elvenkind*. Although in rough shape, they function perfectly fine. The cultist wore a pendant similar to that of the other followers of The Dark One, but it was crushed in the rockslide and the turquoise eyes are missing. The remaining silver chain is worth 5 gp.

AREA 3-19 – THE CAVE-IN

Characters who approach this area from outside the lava tubes spot the cave opening with a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

Beneath a stone overhang is the mouth of a cave, large enough for a human to enter but nearly hidden by the shadows cast by the rock above.

If the characters approach this area from inside the caverns, read the following.

The cavern ahead narrows as it fills with rocky debris. It appears this cavern suffered a cave-in at some point in the past.

Characters on either side of the cave-in can dig through the debris to the other side. Doing so requires a total of four successful DC 18 Strength checks. Remind physically weaker characters that they can use the Help action to grant advantage to a stronger character.

The cultists never spotted the external entrance to this passage and assumed the cave-in was too extensive to clear a path to the outside. As a result, this location offers a potentially unguarded entrance to the lava tube system.

AREA 3-20 – THE SACRIFICIAL PYRE OF THRACIA

A bright orange glow illuminates this large cavern. The smell of sulfur assaults your nostrils, and the ever-present heat you have felt throughout these tunnels becomes a force of its own within the confines of the chamber. Several individuals dressed in matching robes prod two humans, their hands bound, towards a rocky ledge at the opposite side of the room. Judging from the terrified expressions on the faces of the two prisoners, whatever horrible fate the others have planned for them is about to become very real.

Four **acolytes** and two unarmed **commoners** stand on a precipice on the far end of the room. The precipice overlooks a 20-foot drop into a pool of magma below. Unless the characters act immediately, the acolytes push the two prisoners into the magma as sacrifices to The Dark One.

The prisoners speak Modern Thracian and some Common. If rescued, they can lead the characters to where the other kidnapped victims are being held (area 3-7).

Treasure. Each of the acolytes wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). One of them carries a key to area 3-7.

AREA 3-21 – ELEMENTAL ENTRANCE

This passage narrows to a point that human-sized creatures would be forced to squeeze through the tunnel to press further. Hot air continually vents into the corridor from the narrow passage ahead.

Due to its constrictive size, the cultists have ignored this passage, which leads deeper into the volcano where magmins and mephits reside.

Small or Tiny creatures can continue down the passage (towards areas 3-22 through 3-24) with no trouble. Medium creatures can do so only if they squeeze (see the core rulebook for rules on squeezing). Large or larger creatures can't progress further without magical assistance, such as the *enlarge/reduce* spell or a *potion of diminution*.

AREA 3-22 – LAND OF THE LOST

Articles of clothing and other personal effects are heaped haphazardly in this small side passage, as if something were using the items to build a nest.

The collection of rubbish are personal items the mephits stole from the cult members to frustrate or inconvenience them. Most of the items are of no interest to the mephits, but they occasionally pick through them out of curiosity.

The pile contains individual boots and gloves (never a matching pair), random tools (never a complete set of anything), and an assortment of personal items. A character who spends several minutes searching through the collection and succeeds on a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check locates the items listed in the Treasure section, below.

Treasure. Among the items are 28 cp, 16 sp, and several chapters of a book containing a Common/Ignan/Modern Thracian translation guide. The book allows characters who know at least one of those languages to translate written words in either of the other two with a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check. The book doesn't help translate spoken words. At the GM's discretion, each character may also find one random trinket. The rest of the items here are essentially worthless.

AREA 3-23 – MEPHIT PARLOR

The passage eventually opens into a chamber roughly 20 feet across. Several small, fiendish-looking creatures stare at you as you approach.

The creatures are a **magma mephit** and two **smoke mephits**.

Ash, one of the smoke mephits, has learned some Common by studying a book stolen from the cultists (see room 3-22). As the characters approach, he asks the characters what they want, first in Ignan, then Modern Thracian, then Common, and finally in Auran if the characters don't seem to understand the previous languages. If led to believe the characters aren't cultists, the mephits try to recruit the party to clear out the cult, leaving the volcano to the mephits. The mephits can lead the characters to where the kidnapped citizens of Hamlet are being held (see area 3-8). They also know the locations of the cult's barracks (areas 3-5 and 3-9). The mephits are evil and generally untrustworthy, but they want to be left alone in the volcano and will gladly make a temporary alliance with the characters if it serves their purpose.

If the characters attack, the mephits use their breath weapons and retreat to area 3-24. The ceiling of the chamber is only 6 feet high, so the mephits' ability to fly is somewhat limited in this area.

AREA 3-24 – PORTAL POOL

The path ends at a steep drop-off overlooking a flow of glowing magma 40 feet below. As you take in the sights of the chamber, several char-encrusted creatures step out from behind the basalt rubble.

The creatures are a trio of **magmins**. They don't attack immediately and are curious about the characters, having recently arrived from the Elemental Plane of Fire and unfamiliar with creatures native to this plane. If attacked, the creatures dive off the ledge and disappear into the magma below.

Intense heat from the magma radiates throughout the chamber. Every 2 rounds a character spends in the area, they must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or gain a level of exhaustion due to the heat. A creature with immunity or resistance to fire damage automatically succeeds on this save.

GM Note. If the GM wishes to add a side quest to this adventure, the magma might conceal a portal to the Elemental Plane of Fire. Characters who dive into the magma aren't instantly killed but are instead transported to the Elemental Plane of Fire. The denizens of that plane might help the characters return home, as they don't want strange extraplanar beings (such as the characters) intruding in their domain. If you want the characters to return through a different portal, they might reemerge from the magma in area 3-20 or in an appropriate location in *OAR #9: The Caverns of Thracia*.

AREA 3-25 – THE DOME

The ground in the center of this crater gradually rises into a dome, like the convex surface of a giant bubble buried beneath the ground. Fragments of black basalt, weathered reminders of the peak's violent origin, lie scattered throughout the area, prohibiting the growth of all but the hardiest plant life.

The dome was formed when the last lava flow receded, leaving a solid crust above a reservoir of magma far below. The dome has AC 17, 73 hit points, and immunity to fire, necrotic, poison, and psychic damage. It is vulnerable to bludgeoning, force, and thunder damage. Normal activity, such as walking across the dome, is completely safe, but it collapses if reduced to 0 hit points, revealing a pool of magma 70 feet below.

CONCLUDING THE ADVENTURE

If Adamacles (in area 3-7) survives, he gathers whatever allies and prisoners he can and makes his way southwest through the mountains over the course of the following day, eventually retreating to the cult's underground holdings in Thracia.

If the characters defeat Adamacles and return the captured prisoners to Hamlet, the citizenry is overjoyed. A feast is held in the party's honor the following evening. Sawik'it declares the characters honorary citizens of Hamlet. Each character is awarded their own four-room tree house within the settlement. Rope bridges connecting the characters' houses are installed if desired. In addition, if the characters express an interest in continuing their adventuring career (and the GM wishes it), Sawik'it informs them of the ruins to the east (hex 1015), as well as the location of the ruins of Thracia (hex 1317) where, he believes, the cult of The Dark One still holds power.

Finally, Sawik'it hasn't forgotten his promise of "gold" to the characters. At this point, the characters learn the old man's command of Common is somewhat shaky. By "gold," Sawik'it meant "treasure," but as he couldn't find the right word so simply settled on "gold." For their efforts, each character is presented with 80 gp…worth of trade goods. Each character can select whatever combination of cinnamon, cloves, cows, ginger, goats, linen, oxen, pepper, pigs, saffron, silk, or sheep they would like to reach their individual reward. See the core rulebook for the values of various trade goods.

Awarding Experience. If the characters successfully completed the quest for this adventure, allow them to advance to their next level.

APPENDIX A: DOGFOLK AS PLAYER CHARACTERS

Dogfolk are humanoid creatures with the faces, ears, and body hair of various domesticated dogs. They are indigenous to the region around Thracia, but many have traveled to distant corners of the world. Although their exact origin is unknown, some theorize they are a product of magic as opposed to natural evolution. Some even believe dogfolk were created when a powerful wizard sought to elevate the intelligence and abilities of their best friend.

ADOPTIVE PACKS

Dogfolk are social animals and easily form "pack families" not only with dogfolk, but other humanoid creatures as well. Dogfolk are especially fond of gnolls, half-elves, halflings, and humans, and it isn't uncommon to find dogfolk packs that have accepted one or more of these creatures as an adoptive member. Although affectionate by nature, dogfolk are extremely protective of their fellow pack members and may become aggressive towards dogfolk not of their own pack.

DOGFOLK NAMES

Dogfolk usually have names assigned to them by the other creatures they associate with, as dogfolk themselves tend to identify each other by scent. Humanoids that traditionally keep domesticated dogs as pets often assign similar names to their dogfolk associates. Dogfolk may have several names during their life and don't assign significant sentimental value to the names others give them.

Male Dogfolk Names: Buddy, Cooper, Delaney, Fang, Fido, Jack, Max, Muffin, Petey, Rover, Spot, Tucker

Female Dogfolk Names: Bailey, Coco, Daisy, Lady, Lucy, Luna, Moxie, Piper, Rosie, Sadie, Savannah, Sheba

DOGFOLK TRAITS

Your dogfolk character has several of traits in common with all other dogfolk.

Ability Score Increase. One ability score of your choice increases by 2, and one other ability score of your choice increases by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Age. Young dogfolk grow quickly. They attain the size and development of a 10-year-old human child by the age of 4 and reach adulthood just before their teens. They can live between 70 and 80 years.

Alignment. Most dogfolk tend naturally towards chaos, but those who live among other races generally shift their behavior towards lawful to better fit into their society. Dogfolk tend to be friendly, playful, and protective of those they consider friends, and are more often good than not.

Size. Dogfolk range in height from under 5 feet to over 6 feet tall, with a build roughly corresponding to the type of domesticated dog they resemble. Your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 30 feet.

Familial Empathy. Whenever you make a Wisdom (Insight) check to read the general emotional state of another humanoid, you are considered proficient in the Insight skill and add double your proficiency bonus to the check, instead of your normal proficiency bonus. When you reach 3rd level, your prowess in reading emotions allows you to recognize if a creature has been magically charmed or possessed by succeeding at a Wisdom (Insight) check against the DC of the effect (or DC 20, if there was no initial DC).

Instinctive. You gain proficiency in your choice of one of the following skills: Insight, Perception, or Survival.

Keen Hearing and Smell. You have advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Pack Tactics. You have advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of your allies is within 5 feet of your target and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Languages. You can speak, read, and write Common and Gnoll. Gnoll sounds like a mix of the growls, whines, and barks of a canine to those unfamiliar with it. As a result, most dogfolk speak in Common with other races, reserving their use of Gnoll for excited exchanges with other dogfolk.

DOGFOLK SUBRACES

There are many different subraces of dogfolk, each corresponding to a different breed of domesticated dog. Although the physical characteristics (color, length, and curliness of hair; shape, length, and pointedness of ears; shape of snout) of each subrace varies, these differences aren't significant enough to give any subrace an advantage or disadvantage when compared to other breeds.

APPENDIX B: NPCS AND NEW MONSTERS

ADAMACLES

Once a well-respected citizen of Hamlet, Adamacles's thirst for adventure inspired him to lead an expedition to the ruins of Thracia several years ago. After learning about the worship of Thanatos from writings found within the caverns, Adamacles turned his back on Hamlet and formed a new cult of The Dark One (as Thanatos is now known), installing himself as the religion's head priest. Abandoning their former home, Adamacles and his followers took refuge in a complex of ancient lava tubes inside an extinct volcano east of Hamlet. From this stronghold, Adamacles's cult now spreads terror among the jungle's natives, frequently kidnapping people to become undead minions or to serve as sacrifices for their dark god.

ADAMACLES

Medium humanoid (human), neutral evil

Armor Class: 14 (chain shirt and *cloak of protection*)

Hit Points: 32 (5d8 + 10)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
12 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	17 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Str +2, Dex +1, Con +3, Int +3, Wis +6, Cha +6

Skills: Deception +5, Medicine +7, Religion +6

Senses: passive Perception 13

Languages: Common, Modern Thracian

Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Special Equipment: Adamacles wears a *cloak of protection*, which grants him a +1 bonus to AC and saving throws (already included in his statistics). He also wears a pendant bearing a silver skull with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp) and carries the keys to every lockable door in the lava tube complex.

Dread Eminence: As a bonus action, Adamacles can expend a spell slot to cause his melee weapon attacks to magically deal an extra 10 (3d6) necrotic damage on a hit. The effect lasts until the end of his turn. If Adamacles expends a spell slot of 2nd or higher, the extra damage increases by 3 (1d6) for each level above 1st.

Spellcasting: Adamacles is a 5th-level spellcaster. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). Adamacles has the following cleric spells prepared:

- Cantrips (at will): *resistance*, *sacred flame*, *thaumaturgy*
- 1st level (4 slots): *guiding bolt*, *inflict wounds*, *protection from evil and good*
- 2nd level (3 slots): *hold person*, *silence*, *spiritual weapon*
- 3rd level (2 slots): *dispel magic*, *spirit guardians*

ACTIONS

Mace: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

Shortbow: *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, ranged 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) piercing damage.

This dark-skinned male human has a sunken face and wears a pendant with a silver skull motif, identifying himself as a member of the cult of The Dark One. The ornate trim of his robes implies his standing is well above that of a simple cultist, however.

DOGFOLK

At first glance, dogfolk resemble well-manicured gnolls due to their similar canine features. However, dogfolk are an entirely separate race of beastfolk. They act as guides and overseers for the rapacious gnolls of the caverns and are rarely seen outside the palace level or its dungeon complex. Pack creatures by nature, dogfolk consider themselves a single race, regardless of the disparity in their relative height, weight, and appearance. There are dogfolk that bear a resemblance to nearly every type of domesticated dog.

DOGFOLK

Medium humanoid (dogfolk), any alignment

Armor Class: 13 (hide armor)

Hit Points: 22 (5d8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	9 (-1)

Skills: Perception +2

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: Gnoll

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP)

Keen Hearing and Smell: The dogfolk has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Pack Tactics: The dogfolk has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the dogfolk's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage.

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) slashing damage if used with two hands.

This canine-featured humanoid wears hide armor and brandishes a longsword. Its facial features more closely resemble those of a domesticated dog than those of a wolf or fox.

PHORCIDES' FOLLICLE

Phorcides are immortal creatures similar to medusas. According to ancient legends, phorcides shed their green, snake-like locks like mammals shed hair, but with a significant difference: once shed, the snakes are resistant to death and capable of petrifying those that gaze upon them. Phorcides' follicles typically live alone in forests, swamps, ruins, or underground areas.

PHORCIDES' FOLLICLE

Tiny monstrosity, neutral evil

Armor Class: 13

Hit Points: 44 (8d4 + 24)

Speed: 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHR
10 (+0)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	7 (-2)

Skills: Perception +3

Condition Immunities: petrified

Senses: blindsight 10 ft., darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages: understands Common but can't speak

Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Immortal Fortitude: If damage reduces the follicle to 0 hit points, it must make a Constitution saving throw with a DC of 5 + the damage taken, unless the damage is from a critical hit. On a success, the follicle drops to 1 hit point instead.

Petrifying Gaze: When a creature that can see the follicle's eyes starts its turn within 30 feet of the follicle, the follicle can force it to make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw if the follicle isn't incapacitated and can see the creature. If the saving throw fails by 5 or more, the creature is instantly petrified. Otherwise, a creature that fails the save begins to turn to stone and is restrained. The restrained creature must repeat the saving throw at the end of its next turn, becoming petrified on a failure or ending the effect on a success. The petrification lasts until the creature is freed by the *greater restoration* spell or other magic.

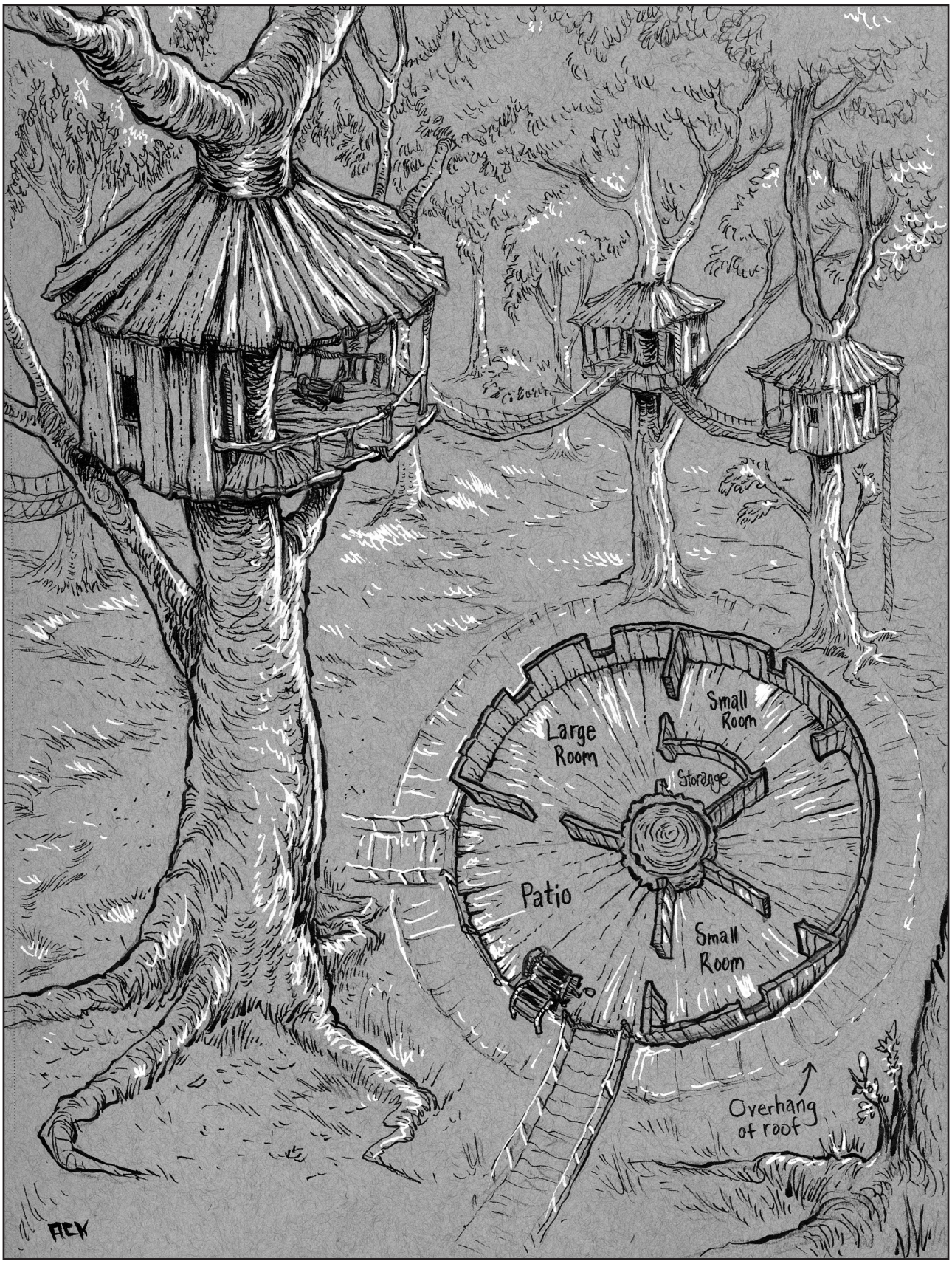
Unless surprised, a creature can avert its eyes to avoid the saving throw at the start of its turn. If the creature does so, it can't see the follicle until the start of its next turn, when it can avert its eyes again. If the creature looks at the follicle in the meantime, it must immediately make the save.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing damage, and the target must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw, taking 14 (4d6) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

You sense an odd malevolence hiding behind the eyes of this tiny green snake.

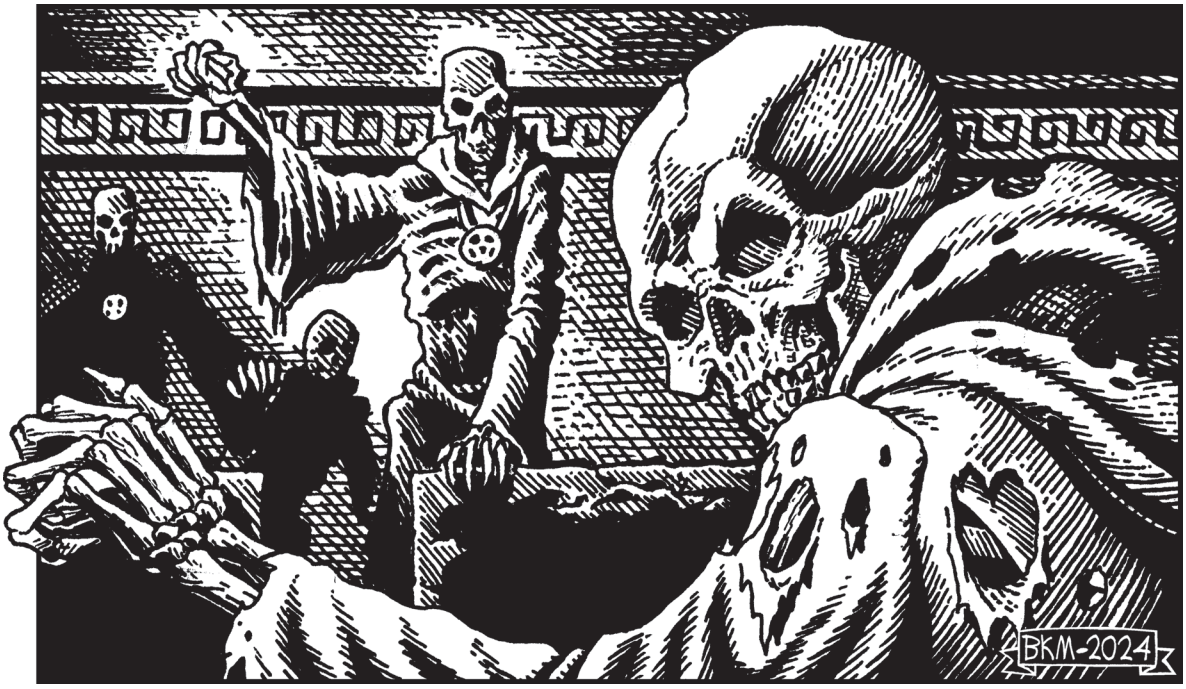
APPENDIX C: PLAYER HANDOUTS



PLAYER HANDOUT 1

FOLLOW THE TRAIL SOUTH OF US ALONG THE RIVER TO THE EAST UNTIL YOU REACH THE MOUNTAINS. THEN HEAD NORTH, KEEPING THE MOUNTAINS TO YOUR RIGHT. YOU WILL EVENTUALLY COME TO A DESERT. CONTINUE TO KEEP THE MOUNTAINS ON YOUR RIGHT UNTIL YOU FIND THE BROKEN MOUNTAIN. THIS IS THE SLEEPING FIRE MOUNTAIN. THOSE THAT WORSHIP THE DARK ONE LIVE INSIDE THE MOUNTAIN. THAT'S WHERE THEY HAVE TAKEN OUR PEOPLE.

PLAYER HANDOUT 2



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